

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 5

How to form a Mu'annath Ism from a Mudhakkar Ism

1. The gender of the Ism at a glance

The division covered in the previous lesson is set out below.

Category	Details
Mudhakkar	An Ism in which no mark of ta'neeth is found
Mu'annath Haqeeqi	Nouns with a masculine counterpart, women's names, and nouns used only for women
Mu'annath 'Alamati (Qiyasi)	The round ة, the Alif Mamdudah , the Alif Maqsurah
Mu'annath Sama'i	Names of winds, wine, fire, cities and countries, and paired parts of the body

The *'Alamati* and the *Sama'i* together make up the *Mu'annath Ghayr Haqeeqi*, which is also called *Mu'annath Majazi* and *Mu'annath Lafzi*.

2. A practical method for determining gender

When a new word is met, its gender is settled by looking at three things in order: first, whether by meaning it is a real masculine or feminine; second, whether any mark of *ta'neeth* appears at its end; and third, whether it belongs to any group of the *Sama'i Mu'annath*. If the answer to all three is no, the word is *Mudhakkar*.

Ism	The test	Verdict
مَسْجِد	Not a real masculine or feminine, no mark of ta'neeth at the end, and not in any Sama'i group	Mudhakkar
جِدَار (wall)	Not a real feminine by meaning, and not in the Sama'i list either	Mudhakkar
دَار (house)	Not a real feminine, but it does appear in the miscellaneous Sama'i list	Mu'annath Sama'i
عَيْن	Not a real feminine, but it belongs to the paired parts of the body	Mu'annath Sama'i

Ism	The test	Verdict
(eye)		
رَجُل (man)	Its meaning shows plainly that it is reserved for a male human being	Mudhakkar Haqeeqi
فَاطِمَة ، زَيْنَب	These are women's names	Mu'annath Haqeeqi

An important rule: If a noun carries a mark of *ta'neeth* but is used for a male, it is still counted *Mudhakkar*. So اُسَامَة (a man's name), عَلَّامَة (a great scholar — an *Ism ul Mubalaghah*) and حَلِيفَة (the name of an office) all end in a round ة yet all three are masculine, because the verdict rests on usage and not on the mark alone.

3. Separate words for real Mudhakkar and Mu'annath

Just as Urdu and English have separate words for real masculine and feminine — man and woman — Arabic too has separate words fixed for certain real masculine and feminine pairs. The same holds for the names of relations. In these words no mark is added to form the feminine; a wholly different word is used.

Real Mudhakkar	Real Mu'annath
رَجُل (man)	اِمْرَاة (woman)
اَب (father)	اُم (mother)
اَخ (brother)	اُخْت (sister)
وَلَد (boy)	بِنْت (girl)

4. First rule: adding a round ة at the end

Besides these, Arabic has masculine nouns whose feminine form is produced by a rule.

Rule: A zabar is placed on the last letter of the *Mudhakkar* noun and a round ة (*Taa' Marbutah*) is added after it.

For instance, Arabic uses اِبْن for a son. Placing a zabar on its final noon and adding a round ة gives اِبْنَة, which means a daughter.

Mudhakkar	The working	Mu'annath
ابن	ابن + ة	ابنة (daughter)
طفل	طفل + ة	طفلة (girl child)
استاذ	استاذ + ة	استاذة (lady teacher)

5. Gender in adjectives

Just as Urdu adjectives distinguish masculine from feminine, Arabic adjectives come in both forms. In Arabic the *Sifah* always agrees with its *Mawsuf* in gender: if the *Mawsuf* is *Mudhakkar*, the *Sifah* is *Mudhakkar* too, and if it is *Mu'annath*, the *Sifah* is brought in the feminine as well.

Agreement between Mawsuf and Sifah

A construction in which the second part states some quality of the first — goodness, badness, quantity, colour and the like — is called a *Murakkab Tawsifi*. Its first part is the *Mawsuf* and its second part the *Sifah*, as in *الْحَجَرُ الْأَسْوَدُ* and *رَجُلٌ جَمِيلٌ*.

In Arabic a *Sifah* agrees with its *Mawsuf* in **four things at once**:

- In number — being *Wahid*, *Tathniyah* or *Jam'*
- In *I'raab* — being *Marfoo'*, *Mansoob* or *Majroor*
- In gender — being *Mudhakkar* or *Mu'annath*
- In definiteness — being *Ma'rifah* or *Nakirah*

This is why one says *رَجُلٌ مُجْتَنِدٌ* and *الرَّجُلُ الْمُجْتَنِدُ*, but the two are never mixed.

The rule

Rule: To form the feminine of an *Ism ul Fa'il*, an *Ism ul Maf'ul* or a *Sifah Mushabbahah*, a zabar is placed on the last letter of the masculine form and a round ة is added after it.

Type	Mudhakkar	Mu'annath
Ism ul Fa'il	قَاتِل (one who kills)	قَاتِلَةٌ
Ism ul Maf'ul	مَقْتُول (one who is killed)	مَقْتُولَةٌ
Sifah Mushabbahah	جَمِيل (beautiful)	جَمِيلَةٌ

A *Sifah Mushabbahah* is a quality that is permanently present.

6. Second rule: colours and defects

In Arabic grammar colours are called *Alwan* and defects '*Uyub*'. The adjectives of both are made feminine by one and the same special rule.

The masculine colours are: أَسْوَد (black), أَبْيَض (white), أَزْرَق (blue), أَحْمَر (red), أَخْضَر (green) and أَصْفَر (yellow). Each of these masculine adjectives begins with an additional hamzah carrying a zabar, while the root letters are three, so the root of أَسْوَد is س و د.

Rule: First the additional hamzah of the masculine adjective is removed and its root letters are taken. Then a zabar is placed on the first root letter, the second is made *sakin*, and a zabar is placed on the third. Finally an alif and a hamzah are added at the end. This alif and hamzah are additional and are called the *Alif Mamdudah*; and it is this *Alif Mamdudah* that becomes the mark of the feminine.

Mudhakkar	Root letters	The working	Mu'annath
أَسْوَد	س و د	سَوْدَ + اء	سَوْدَاء
أَخْضَر	خ ض ر	خَضَرَ + اء	خَضْرَاء
أَصْفَر	ص ف ر	صَفَرَ + اء	صَفْرَاء
أَبْكَم	ب ك م	بَكَمَ + اء	بَكْمَاء
أَعْرَج	ع ر ج	عَرَجَ + اء	عَرَجَاء

The last two rows are examples of '*Uyub*': أَبْكَم means mute and its feminine is بَكْمَاء, while أَعْرَج means lame and its feminine is عَرَجَاء.

7. Third rule: the Ism ut Tafdeel

The *Ism ut Tafdeel* expresses a greater or the greatest degree of some quality, and it too has distinct masculine and feminine forms.

In terminology an *Ism ut Tafdeel* is a derived noun that denotes an entity in which the meaning of the *masdar* is found in greater measure than in others. The one in whom the excess is found is called the *Mufaddal*, and the one against whom it is measured is the *Mufaddal 'Alayh*. So in أَلْأَسْنَدُ أَفْضَلُ مِنَ التَّلْمِيزِ, the word أَلْأَسْنَدُ is the *Mufaddal* and التَّلْمِيزِ the *Mufaddal 'Alayh*.

Rule: A pesh is placed on the first root letter of the *Ism ut Tafdeel*, the second is made *sakin*, a zabar is placed on the third, and an *Alif Maqsurah* is added at the end. In other words, the masculine pattern is **فَعْلٌ** and the feminine pattern is **فُعْلَى**.

Mudhakkar	Root letters	The working	Mu'annath
أَكْبَرُ	ك ب ر	كُبِرَ + ي	كُبِرَى
أَصْغَرُ	ص غ ر	صُغِرَ + ي	صُغِرَى
أَحْسَنُ	ح س ن	حُسِنَ + ي	حُسِنَى
أَعْظَمُ	ع ظ م	عُظِمَ + ي	عُظِمَى

It should also be kept in view that in Arabic the *Ism ut Tafdeel* is generally used as an adjective, whereas among us these same words have become current as masculine and feminine personal names. By the rules of Arabic their proper use is adjectival.

The three ways the *Ism ut Tafdeel* is used

- With *alif lam*, as in **جَاءَ زَيْدٌ الْأَفْضَلُ** (the excellent Zayd came)
- With *من*, as in **زَيْدٌ أَفْضَلُ مِنْ عَمْرٍو** (Zayd is more excellent than 'Amr)
- With *idafah*, as in **زَيْدٌ أَفْضَلُ الْقَوْمِ** (Zayd is the most excellent of the people)

Some rules of gender for the *Ism ut Tafdeel*

- When an *Ism ut Tafdeel* is used with *من*, it always stays singular masculine, even if the *Mawsuf* is feminine, as in **سَلِمَى أَحْوَدُ مِنْ أُخْتِهَا**
- If the *Ism ut Tafdeel* is annexed to a *Nakirah*, it must again be singular masculine, as in **زَيْنَبُ أَكْبَرُ إِمْرَأَةٍ**
- If the *Ism ut Tafdeel* carries *alif lam*, it must agree with its *Mawsuf*, as in **الْفَاطِمَةُ الْفُضْلَى** and **الْفَاطِمَاتُ الْفُضْلَيَاتُ**

An exception: Through frequency of use the hamzah of some *Ism ut Tafdeel* forms is dropped, as in **أَشَرَّ** and **أَخْبَرَّ** — originally **شَرٌّ** and **خَبَرٌّ**.

8. The three rules compared

Setting all three rules side by side completes the picture.

In which category	Masculine form	Feminine form	Example
Ism, Ism ul Fa'il, Ism ul Ma'ul and Sifah Mushabbahah	unchanged	add ه at the end	قَاتِل ← قَاتِلَة
Colours (Alwan) and defects ('Uyub)	أَفْعَل	فَعْلَاء	أَسْوَد ← سَوْدَاء
Ism ut Tafdeel	أَفْعَل	فُعْلَى	أَكْبَر ← كُبْرَى

Worth noting: Both colours and defects on the one hand, and the *Ism ut Tafdeel* on the other, share the masculine pattern أَفْعَل, yet their feminine forms differ. The decision rests on meaning: if the word denotes a colour or a physical defect, its feminine comes on the pattern فَعْلَاء; and if it conveys comparison or superiority, its feminine comes on the pattern فُعْلَى.

Summary

1. To determine the gender of a noun, three things are checked in order: its meaning, any mark of ta'neeth, and the groups of the Sama'i Mu'annath.
2. If a noun carries a mark of ta'neeth but is used for a male, it is still Mudhakkar, as in **أَسَامَةُ**, **عَلَامَةُ** and **خَلِيفَةُ**.
3. For some real masculine and feminine pairs Arabic has entirely separate words, as **رَجُلٌ** and **إِمْرَأَةٌ**, or **أَخٌ** and **أُخْتُ**.
4. First rule: place a zabar on the last letter of the Mudhakkar and add a round ة, as **ابْنٌ** becomes **ابْنَةٌ**.
5. In Arabic a Sifah always agrees with its Mawsuf in gender.
6. A Sifah agrees with its Mawsuf in four things: number, I'raab, gender, and definiteness.
7. The feminine of an Ism ul Fa'il, an Ism ul Ma'f'ul and a Sifah Mushabbahah is likewise formed by adding a round ة.
8. The second rule belongs to colours (Alwan) and defects ('Uyub): masculine pattern **أَفْعَلٌ**, feminine pattern **فَعْلَاءٌ**.
9. In the feminine of a colour or defect the final alif and hamzah are additional; this is the Alif Mamdudah, and it is the mark of the feminine.
10. The third rule belongs to the Ism ut Tafdeel: masculine pattern **أَفْعَلٌ**, feminine pattern **فُعْلَى**, as **كَبُرَ** gives **كُبُرَى**.
11. In an Ism ut Tafdeel the one given preference is the Mufaddal and the one measured against is the Mufaddal 'Alayh.
12. The Ism ut Tafdeel is used in three ways: with alif lam, with **مِنْ**, and with idafah.
13. With **مِنْ** the Ism ut Tafdeel always remains singular masculine, even when the Mawsuf is feminine.
14. **خَيْرٌ** and **شَرٌّ** were originally **أَخَيْرٌ** and **أَشَرٌّ**; their hamzah was dropped through frequency of use.
15. The pattern **أَفْعَلٌ** serves both colours and defects and the Ism ut Tafdeel; the difference appears in the feminine, and meaning decides which pattern applies.

Exercise

1. Write the three stages, in order, for determining the gender of a new noun.
2. **دَارٌ** and **جَدَارٌ** are both lifeless things, so why is one Mu'annath and the other Mudhakkar?
3. Why are **أَسَامَةُ**, **عَلَامَةُ** and **خَلِيفَةُ** masculine despite ending in a round ة?
4. Write four pairs in which the masculine and the feminine are entirely separate words.
5. Form the feminine of the following: **طِفْلٌ**, **أُسْتَاذٌ**, **مُسْلِمٌ**, **مُعَلِّمٌ**.
6. In which four things does a Sifah agree with its Mawsuf?
7. Write the masculine and feminine forms of the Ism ul Fa'il, the Ism ul Ma'f'ul and the Sifah Mushabbahah, with one example each.
8. Separate the root letters of **أَبْيَضٌ**, **أَحْمَرٌ** and **أَزْرَقٌ**, then form their feminine.

9. Give the meanings of أَغْرَجَ and أَبْكَمَ and form their feminine by the rule.
10. Form the feminine of أَصْغَرَ , أَحْسَنَ and أَعْظَمَ , and write the rule as well.
11. Explain all three ways in which the Ism ut Tafdeel is used, with examples.
12. Write two words on the pattern أَفْعَلْ, one a colour and one an Ism ut Tafdeel, form the feminine of both and bring out the difference.

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ